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DJIA 43461.21 ▲ 33.19 0.08% NASDAQ 19286.92 ▼ 1.2% STOXX 600 553.39 ▼ 0.1% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 7/32, yield 4.390% OIL \$70.70 ▲ \$0.30 GOLD \$2,947.90 ▲ \$10.30 EURO \$1.0469 YEN 149.71

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Apple said it plans** to spend more than \$500 billion over the next four years to expand its manufacturing footprint in the U.S., an initiative that would include building a factory in Houston. **B1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** ended mixed, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq falling 0.5% and 1.2%, respectively, and the Dow industrials rising 0.1%. **B9**

◆ **A services bundle** that Disney and Warner Bros. Discovery launched in July showed early signs of success in subscriber retention. **B1**

◆ **Veteran broadcaster** Lester Holt told network staff that he would step down as anchor of "NBC Nightly News," a role he has held since mid-2015. **B1**

◆ **Apollo is set to buy** publicly traded real-estate investment firm Bridge in an effort to fill a gap in its investment offerings. **B3**

◆ **Italian energy-services** provider Saipem will merge with Norwegian rival Subsea7 in a deal valued at around \$4.86 billion, creating a global giant. **B3**

◆ **Anthropic is completing** a \$3.5 billion funding round that values the creator of chatbot Claude at \$61.5 billion after assuaging investor anxieties about the success of DeepSeek. **B3**

◆ **Thermo Fisher Scientific** is nearing a deal for Solventum's purification and filtration business that people familiar with the matter said could value the target at between \$3.5 billion and \$4 billion. **B3**

◆ **U.S. dockworkers were** expected to ratify a new contract that their union leaders heralded as a historic win with a 62% pay increase and clauses governing automation. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump endorsed** Elon Musk's demand that federal workers summarize their weekly accomplishments or face termination, an order that agency leaders interpreted with conflicting guidance about whether and how employees should respond. **A1**

◆ **The U.S. sided with** Russia, Belarus and North Korea against a U.N. resolution condemning Moscow for the war in Ukraine, a major shift as Trump said he was in talks with Russia about an economic-development deal. **A1**

◆ **The leaders of China** and Russia expressed mutual solidarity as the war in Ukraine lengthened. **A8**

◆ **The Trump administration** proposed to slap steep fees on Chinese shipping companies and any Chinese-built vessels that enter U.S. ports. **A2**

◆ **Israel and the U.S.** pressed Hamas to extend the first phase of a Gaza cease-fire and delay a discussion of the hardest parts of a pact that would end the conflict. **A9**

◆ **The EU, Syria's biggest** pre-war trading partner, moved to end the country's economic isolation by easing energy and banking sanctions. **A9**

◆ **New York Mayor** Eric Adams said his administration would shut the Roosevelt Hotel, one of the city's highest-profile migrant shelters. **A3**

◆ **The Republican National** Committee learned in July that hackers with ties to the Chinese government had for months had access to its email system after a breach. **A4**

◆ **Died: Roberta Flack**, 88, acclaimed singer-songwriter. **A6**

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A woman placed a candle Monday at a Kyiv shrine to fallen fighters on the third anniversary of Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

U.S. Sides With Russia, China Against Ukraine in U.N. Vote

Resolution calls for swift end to war, but doesn't offer blame; Trump courts Putin

By Laurence Norman, Annie Linskey and Jane Lytvynenko

crafted in Washington that didn't blame Moscow for the Ukraine war and called for a swift end to the conflict, as President Trump said he was

in talks with Russia about an economic-development deal.

Trump's comments and the U.S.'s actions at the U.N. on Monday illustrated the extent to which the president has changed the U.S.'s posture toward the region, coming on the same day European leaders gathered in Ukraine's capital to mark the third anniversary of the invasion.

Earlier on Monday, the General Assembly, which represents the 193 U.N. member states, had approved a Ukrainian resolution pinning the blame on Russia for the war, despite U.S. efforts to kill it. The U.S. was joined by North Korea, Russia and Belarus in

voting against it.

Unlike the General Assembly, the 15-member U.N. Security Council has decision-making powers. The U.S. secured 10 votes from the Security Council in favor of its resolution. Five European countries abstained, including the U.K. and France, underscoring the widening gulf between Europe and the U.S. over the Ukraine conflict.

France and Britain both have veto powers on the Security Council, but were reluctant to use them against Washington, diplomats said. President Emmanuel Macron of France met with Trump at the White House on Monday, and U.K. Prime Minister Keir Starmer is

set to meet with Trump in Washington this week.

The Biden administration took pride in leading Western powers in an alliance against President Vladimir Putin of Russia, marshaling a far-reaching effort to punish Moscow through economic sanctions. Then-President Joe Biden, a Democrat, emerged as a leading critic of Putin on the world stage and framed the conflict as one of democracy versus autocracy.

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◆ **Loss of U.S. weapons will hurt Ukraine.....** A7

◆ **Putin and Xi bolster ties as war drags on.....** A8

Firms Get Creative In Pledges To Create U.S. Jobs

iPhone boxes carry a stamp saying they are designed by Apple in California. Smaller print makes clear one of America's biggest manufacturing successes is mostly imported from China, where millions of people working for overseas contractors assemble

By Aaron Tilley, Theo Francis and Amrith Ramkumar

the phones.

Early in the second Trump administration, Apple and other companies are trying to quickly answer the president's call to rouse U.S. manufacturing. To do that, they are turning to investments and job growth that include previously planned spending or developments already under way.

Apple, like many of the most valuable U.S. companies, isn't a major manufacturer. It designs products, writes software and creates chip blueprints, but outsources much of its production and markets the result. With the Trump administration imposing tariffs on Chinese imports and urging a renaissance of U.S. manufacturing, Apple is turning to a familiar playbook.

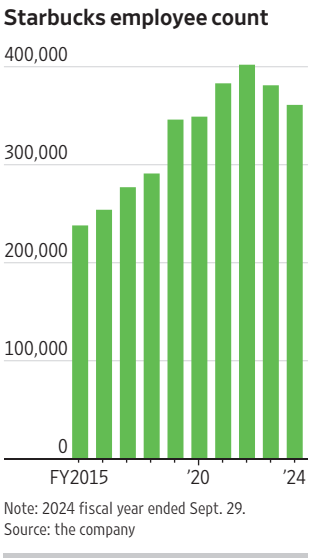
Chief Executive Tim Cook on Monday trumpeted plans to spend \$500 billion in the

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◆ **Apple pledges \$500 billion to build U.S. plant.....** B1

Starbucks Set For Layoffs

New CEO Brian Niccol says the chain will lay off 1,100 corporate employees and leave open roles empty. **B1**



Larry Ellison's Bid to Change Farming Has Been a Bust

He's spent half a billion but hasn't been able to boost output and nutrition in greenhouses with AI, robotics and software

By TOM DOTAN

In a row of six greenhouses on a remote stretch of the Hawaiian island of Lanai, Larry Ellison is trying to use his golden touch in tech to remake the way people around the world eat. The company behind his effort, Sensei Ag, is eight years in the making and has cost the world's fourth-richest person more than half a billion dollars—far more than he spent buying the island itself. Early on, Ellison touted cutting-edge technology that would modernize agriculture, make a big impact for society and eventually help grow food in places such as Africa. The billionaire has told executives he sees the project as part of his legacy.

So far, it's mostly been a bust.

Little of the revolutionary tech the company has extolled—sensors to monitor development, artificial intelligence to breed crop varieties and robots to harvest plants—is being used, according to people familiar with Sensei. The company has been beset by problems typical to tech startups, including executive changeovers, shifting goals and bad Wi-Fi. It has also stumbled from farming inexperience. The greenhouses, for example, weren't built to withstand Lanai's strong winds and their solar panels have broken down. Some of its top executives are tech veterans who have no commercial agricultural experience.

The 80-year-old Ellison and his Sensei Ag co-founder, celebrity doctor David Agus, envi-

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Everyone Hates Pennies—Except This Guy

Lobbyist faces biggest fight yet to keep coin as currency instead of a collectible

By JOSEPH PISANI

Whenever the penny is threatened, one man stands up to defend it.

Mark Weller has been on a roll for three decades, arguing for the one-cent coin's existence every chance he gets.

When the penny is slighted in newspapers, it's Weller who writes letters to the editor. He's extolled the coin's virtues on television and radio shows. The pro-penny group he runs,



Centimental

Americans for Common Cents, spits out facts to lawmakers about the benefits of the smallest unit of U.S. currency. And he's been to Capitol Hill countless times to convince Congress to keep the penny, which the U.S. Mint has been producing since 1793.

"The penny is wanted, needed, and appreciated," he said in written testimony in 2012.

Giving his two cents about the one cent isn't just Weller's passion. It's his job: He's a

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Trump Backs Musk's Email to Workers

But it remained unclear if order to cite accomplishments for week was mandatory

WASHINGTON—President Trump endorsed Elon Musk's demand that federal workers summarize their weekly accomplishments or face termination, an order that agency leaders interpreted in conflicting guidance over whether and how employees should respond.

By Brian Schwartz, Ken Thomas and Lindsay Ellis

Trump said he thought the weekend email sent to more than two million federal workers under the subject line "What did you do last week?" was "great because we have people that don't show up to work, and nobody even knows if they work for the government."

"If you don't answer, like you're sort of semi-fired, or you're fired because a lot of people are not answering because they don't even exist," Trump said during an appearance at the Oval Office on Monday with President Emmanuel Macron of France.

The email prompted confusion across the federal workforce. Staff from the Office of Personnel Management told senior officials that responding to the email was voluntary and that declining to do so by the end of Monday, as instructed, wouldn't result in termination, people familiar with the discussion said.

Workers in agencies in

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◆ **DOJ lawyers struggle** amid blitz of Trump actions... **A4**

INSIDE



OBITUARY

Roberta Flack, the soulful star behind 'Killing Me Softly With His Song,' at 88. **A14**



BUSINESS & FINANCE

Theranos founder Elizabeth Holmes loses bid to overturn her conviction. **B1**